

Transformation Roadmap - Research Design

2. RESEARCH DESIGN OVERHAUL

Current:
Single-year cross-section with bivariate tests

Needed: Three Options

Option A: Panel Data Design (Preferred)

- Collect 5-10 years of data - Implement fixed effects regression - Model: $Z\text{-score}(it) = \alpha + \beta \cdot \text{Governance}(it) + \text{Hospital}(i) + \text{Year}(t) + \varepsilon$ - Controls for time-invariant hospital characteristics

Option B: Quasi-Experimental Design

- Identify policy shock (e.g., 2024 ULS integration reform) - Difference-in-differences: - Treatment: Hospitals merged into ULS - Control: Hospitals not yet merged - Measure: Financial metrics before/after

Option C: Comparative Design

- Compare Greek hospitals to: → Portuguese SNS (similar system, different outcomes) → Greek private hospitals (market discipline effect) → Pre/post economic crisis (2008-2015)

